WUNGRAM OKTHOT: THE NOVEL OF HIGHLAND HERITAGE AND CLAN TRI

Wungram: A Chronicle of Tangkhul Highland Life

Author / Compiler: Tangkhul Cultural Council

Publisher: Wung Cultural Forum, Ukhrul

Year: 1998 | Genre: Novel (Upanyas), Ethnohistory & Cultural Heritage

PREFACE & HISTORICAL CONTEXT

Wungram Okthot weaves ethnohistorical authenticity with powerful novelistic storytelling. It preserves traditional terminology for ancient rituals, clan feasts of merit (Maron), wood-carving on village gates (Kharashim), and the philosophical foundations of Tangkhul identity.

Archival Catalog Reference: WCF-TKH-NOVEL-WUNGRAM

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CHAPTER 1: THE FEAST OF MERIT (MARON KASA)

Summary: Depicts an elder staging the grand feast of merit, erecting sacrificial monolith...

Tangkhul Text:

Chapter 1: Wungram elder akhana Maron (Feast of Merit) sakhavai ningkashang leisai. Maron kasana village-li sapha-kashang khangam machitheila, awui lungkashung eina mikumo pupupli kachak kala khor milaga village unity ngashankhavai leisai. Ana cattle thakhara shaksarlaga shang pupupli ngashanserie. Kala awui shim-ngalemli lungphung monolith akha kakor-hamsangie.

English Translation / Meaning:

An elder of Wungram resolved to perform the solemn Feast of Merit (Maron). This feast was intended not for vain ostentation, but to generously distribute cattle meat and rice brew to every clan, thereby cementing the spiritual and social unity of the village. He slaughtered cattle and distributed portions to all clans, and erected a memorial monolith beside his homestead.

CHAPTER 1 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Key Vocabulary Entries:

*** Maron (noun): feast of merit, traditional philanthropic festival**

Ex: Maron sakhavai.

*** lungphung monolith (noun): standing stone monument commemorating merit**

Ex: Monolith kakor-ham.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Socio-religious feast terminology: 'Maron kasa'.
- Philanthropic motive clauses: redistributive economic structure.

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] What was the social purpose of the Feast of Merit in Tangkhul tradition?

[?] Identify the structural components of the feast.

CHAPTER 1 -- LITERARY & BIOGRAPHICAL COMMENTARY

Literary Analysis & Historical Significance:
This chapter illustrates quintessential Tangkhul cultural ethics, clan loyalty, and narrative style.

Stylistic and Discourse Notes:

Standard literary Tangkhul is employed throughout, preserving classic oral idioms,
traditional honorifics, and vivid metaphorical descriptions.

CHAPTER 2: THE CARVING OF THE VILLAGE GATE (KHARASHIM TARUNG)

Summary: Master woodcarvers adorn the sacred village entrance gate with horned mithun emb...

Tangkhul Text:

Chapter 2: Village-wui gate (Kharashim) kathara sakhavai, thing-artisanbingna Tarung kashang thingphun khuilaga village-li phung-ungserie. Athumna mithun (siel) horn, kazing-sira, kala warriors-wui emblem kaphamei khak-saye. Kharashim china village-li kashikashili eina huikhuikhavai sacred barrier thada kasaye.

English Translation / Meaning:

To renew the village gateway (Kharashim), master artisans carried the sacred Tarung timber from the virgin forest. With adzes and chisels, they carved motifs of mithun horns, celestial stars, and brave warriors. The consecrated gate served as both a physical fortification and a spiritual shield safeguarding the village from evil.

CHAPTER 2 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Key Vocabulary Entries:

*** Kharashim (noun): monumental village gateway, fortified portal**

Ex: Kharashim gate.

*** Tarung (noun): sacred ceremonial Y-shaped wooden post**

Ex: Tarung thingphun.

*** siel horn (noun): mithun horn motif symbolizing wealth and fertility**

Ex: Siel horn khak-sa.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Woodcarving and architectural terminology in Tangkhul.
- Symbolic semiotics of mithun and star emblems.

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Explain the symbolic motifs carved on traditional Tangkhul village gates.

[?] What material is used for carving the Tarung?

CHAPTER 2 -- LITERARY & BIOGRAPHICAL COMMENTARY

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Stylistic and Discourse Notes:

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CHAPTER 3: THE COVENANT OF THE FOUR MOUNTAIN VILLAGES

Summary: Four historically warring mountain settlements establish a permanent peace pact ...

Tangkhul Text:

Chapter 3: Kaphung matiwui village-bingna ngaburlaga peace treaty sakahaisai. Athumna haikapha salaga: ’Ithui yaronaobingna warfare kashikahailaga luiramli ot sara; ithui ngalanaobingna inter-marriage eina shangli unity phungsara.’ Wungram kaphung tharili peace-wui mayangwon shokserie.

English Translation / Meaning:

The four mountain villages assembled and consecrated a permanent peace pact. They solemnly pledged: ’Our youth shall cast aside war and till the terraced fields; our daughters shall unite the clans through honorable intermarriage.’ And over the heights of Wungram, the rainbow of enduring peace shone bright.

CHAPTER 3 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Key Vocabulary Entries:

*** kaphung mati (noun): four mountain villages / territories**

Ex: Kaphung matiwui.

*** mayangwon (noun): rainbow of peace and reconciliation**

Ex: Peace-wui mayangwon.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Treaty resolution parallelism: youths till fields; maidens unite clans through marriage.

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Summarize the terms of the peace pact.

CHAPTER 3 -- LITERARY & BIOGRAPHICAL COMMENTARY

Literary Analysis & Historical Significance:
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Stylistic and Discourse Notes:

Standard literary Tangkhul is employed throughout, preserving classic oral idioms,
traditional honorifics, and vivid metaphorical descriptions.

BACK MATTER: GLOSSARY & DIGITIZATION COLOPHON

Consolidated Vocabulary Summary:

* Maron -- feast of merit, traditional philanthropic festival
* lungphung monolith -- standing stone monument commemorating merit
* Kharashim -- monumental village gateway, fortified portal
* Tarung -- sacred ceremonial Y-shaped wooden post
* siel horn -- mithun horn motif symbolizing wealth and fertility
* kaphung mati -- four mountain villages / territories
* mayangwon -- rainbow of peace and reconciliation

Preservation Colophon:

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